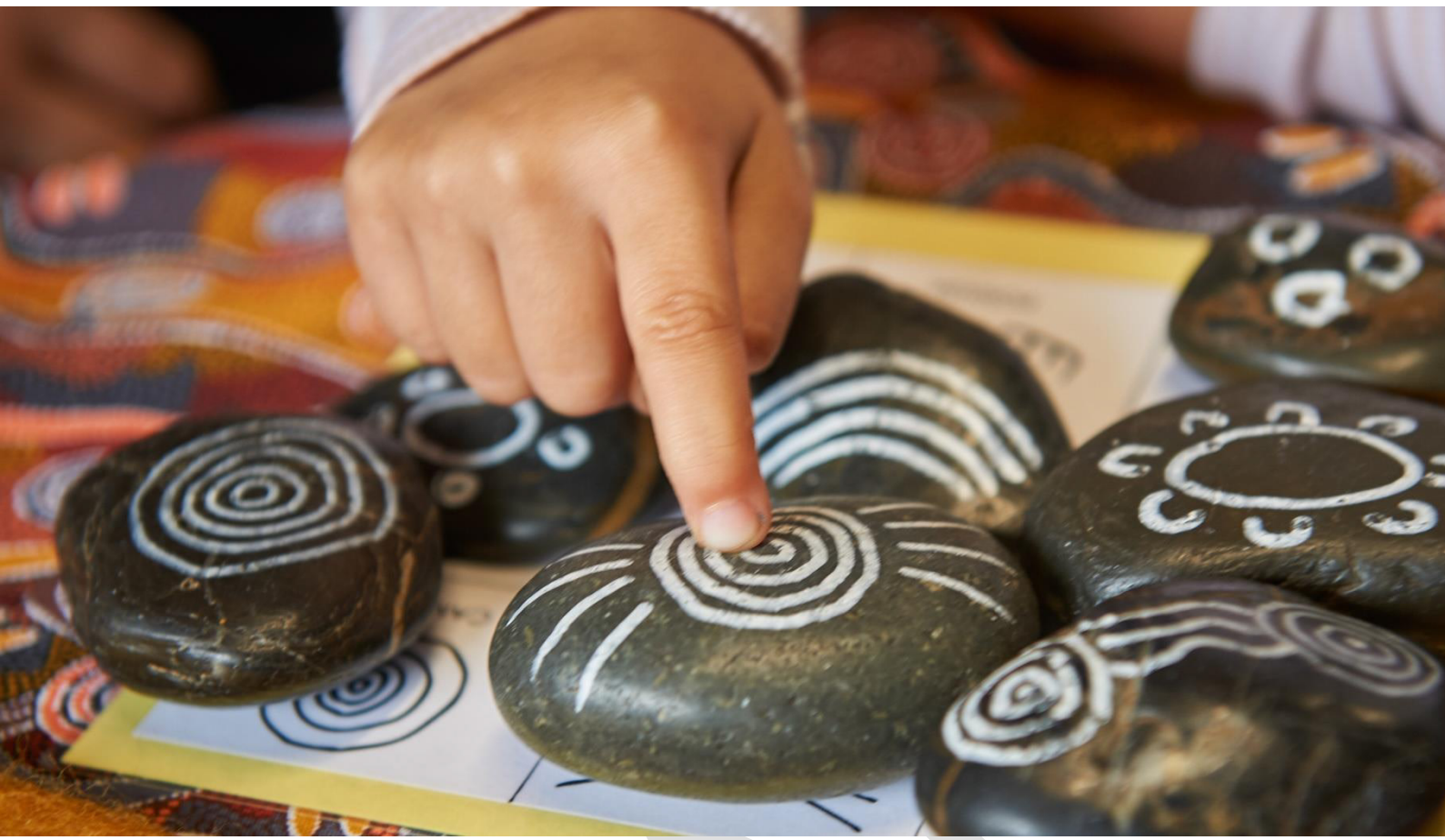




Kindergarten Learning Progression Language and literacy

Validated version

Australian Council for Educational Research
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Kindergarten Learning Progression

Language and literacy

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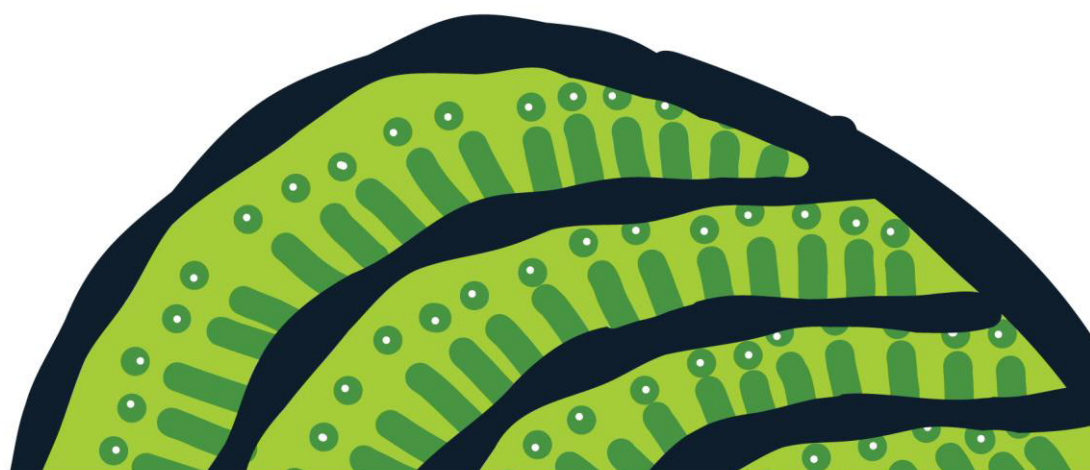
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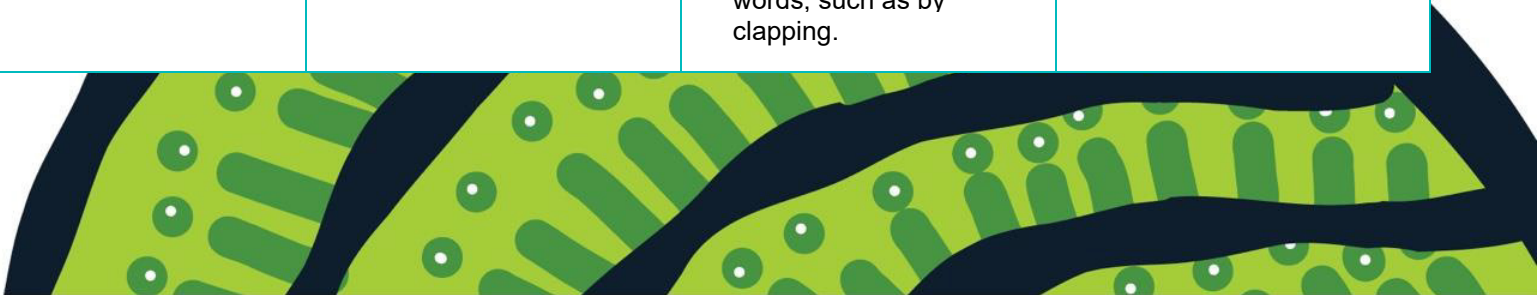


Kindergarten Learning Progression Language and literacy

Observable changes in children’s learning and development

Links to QKLG: Communicating

Sounds and speech							
Words and sentences	- Speaks (communicates) using a very limited range of single words. - May gesture instead of, or as well as, speaking.	- Speaks (communicates) briefly using single words and 2-3 word phrases. Ideas are rarely linked. - Uses a limited vocabulary that may mainly be nouns.	- Speaks (communicates) briefly in short sentences or phrases (e.g., up to 4 words) attempting to link some ideas, using a small range of simple, common words. - Speech (communication) may be disordered (e.g., incorrect sentence structure (syntax)) with some confusion about word meaning. - May be hard to follow at times.	- Speaks (communicates) in sentences of up to 5-6 words. May use one or two conjunctions (mainly 'and') and one or two pronouns making some errors. - Mainly uses simple, common nouns and a limited range of verbs appropriately to convey meaning.	- Speaks (communicates) for several sentences (e.g., 35+ words) mainly using 2-3 simple conjunctions (e.g., 'and', 'then', 'so') - Speech (communication) mostly uses correct word order (syntax). - Uses many common nouns, and some simple verbs and adjectives appropriately to convey meaning.	- Uses some longer sentences (e.g., 7+ words) when speaking (communicating) and 3-4 common conjunctions (e.g., and, but, because, then). - Uses personal pronouns (e.g., 'I', 'me', 'you' 'we', 'us', 'he', 'she') and a wide variety of common nouns, verbs and adjectives appropriately to convey meaning.	- Uses many long sentences and 5-6 conjunctions (e.g., and, but, because, then, so, after) and a range of pronouns when speaking. - Uses a wide range of common words, including words and constructions from story books and in everyday speech.
Storytelling and conversations	Insufficient language to understand or respond to most simple questions or make requests.	Mainly relies on gesture in responding to questions or making requests (e.g., shakes head, or points).	Tells a short personal story (child's own experiences, thoughts or feelings) that jumps between linked ideas and/or events. Makes a few short simple, familiar requests (e.g., 'More please'). Mostly responds to questions with a single word (e.g., yes/no).	- Tells a personal story (child's own experiences, thoughts or feelings) that has some details that are not clearly distinguished from events. - Has short conversations about predictable and familiar topics (e.g., what they are playing with). - Asks broad or general questions (e.g., 'what', 'where', or 'who'). - Responds briefly to a variety of questions and makes simple requests.	- Tells a personal story (child's own experiences, thoughts or feelings) that has a logical flow beginning, middle and end). - Has conversations about a range of familiar topics mostly from their immediate context (e.g., what they are doing at the time). - Contributes relevant ideas. - Asks a range of specific questions that relate to the topic.	- Tells a longer personal story (child's own experiences, thoughts or feelings) that is well structured, providing some details to improve or clarify the story in response to questions. - Has thoughtful conversations, including some less familiar topics outside their immediate context.	- Tells a longer, detailed personal story (child's own experiences, thoughts or feelings) that is well structured, identifying the problem/main event and resolution, without being asked prompting questions. - Contributes considered ideas to conversations. - Asks questions that build on or clarify their understanding.
Sounds in words	Requires modelling and support to say recognisable words.	- Repeats words of 2-4 syllables but only says some of the sounds (e.g., child might say "elephant" as "el-fant,"). - Everyday words are often unclear.	Talk is mostly clear in conversations.	Repeats 2 and 3-syllable words and says all of the sounds.	- Repeats an unfamiliar 4-syllable word and says all the sounds. - Talks clearly in conversations.	- Identifies when the first sounds in words are the same and when they are not. - Identifies if words rhyme or not - Generates a word that rhymes including both real (e.g., 'cat' and 'hat') and nonsense words (e.g., 'lat'). - Can identify syllables in words, such as by clapping.	



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Comprehension							
Retelling, interpreting, linking and evaluating		• Uses pictures in a book to answer questions about the main characters or problem in the story. • Labels 3-4 very familiar objects in the illustrations. • Refers to one key idea in a short and simple story (e.g., the main event, the main character).	• Retells the key ideas from a short and simple text (2-3). • Names most of the objects in the illustrations that are key to the story. • Interprets simple ideas (e.g., how a character is feeling) from explicit clues or an illustration. • Links simple ideas (e.g., cause and effect – watering the plant makes it grow) for a predictable, familiar event.	• Retells the story including most key ideas from throughout a simple text. • Interprets simple, implied ideas (e.g., a secondary character’s feelings). • Links cause and effect for most key events or characters’ motivations (e.g., characters decision to share their toys made their friend happy).	• Explains a range of implied ideas (e.g., the reason for a character’s behaviour). • Makes simple, obvious comparisons (e.g., about a predictable change in a story – ‘The caterpillar spins a cocoon and changes into a butterfly’), and obvious predictions (‘The character will find the treasure in the cave because he has a treasure map’). • Makes links between well separated ideas (e.g., where there are several events or cumulative causes that lead to an effect – the steps to planting a seed). • Gives a simple reason for their opinion.	• Explains a range of implied ideas with some sophistication (e.g., a character’s subtly communicated motivation). • Makes comparisons between viewpoints (e.g., compares one character’s view to another) and makes generalisations from explicit clues. • Gives synonyms or antonyms for highly familiar words (e.g., mad means angry). • Makes links between a series of events (e.g., to sequence a short story). • Gives evidence to support their opinion (e.g., why a character behaved as they did).	
Text purpose		• Selects books with textural features such as lift-the-flaps, tactile surfaces, sounds and minimal, simple labels. • Attends to the sensory features of books designed for this developmental stage.	• Selects a highly familiar, preferred book, holds it the right way up based on key features such as the front cover or illustrations that interest them. • Recognises some familiar environmental print (e.g., name of centre, logo) based on clues such as graphics and location.	• Explains the purpose of highly familiar texts (e.g., this text tells a story, this one is for cooking, this is a shopping list). • Distinguishes factual texts from fictional texts.	• Explains the purpose of a few distinct text types and features (e.g., fairytales, nursery rhymes, show and tell).	• Explains the purpose of a range of familiar text types and features (e.g., Dreamtime stories, recipes, craft instructions, fables, myths, lists, labels).	

